Progress Check

Examine if (3,3) will be a solution for the simultaneous linear equations $2x - 5y - 2 = 0$ and $x + y - 6 = 0$ by drawing a graph.

3.8.2 Methods of solving simultaneous linear equations

There are different methods to find the solution of a pair of simultaneous linear equations. It can be broadly classified as geometric way and algebraic ways.

Geometric way	Algebraic ways
1. Graphical method	1. Substitution method
	2. Elimination method
	3. Cross multiplication method

Solving by Graphical Method

Already we have seen graphical representation of linear equation in two variables. Here we shall learn, how we are graphically representing a pair of linear equations in two variables and find the solution of simultaneous linear equations.

Example 3.44

Use graphical method to solve the following system of equations: $x + y = 5$; $2x - y = 4$.

Solution

Given $x + y = 5$ ...(1)

$2x - y = 4$ ...(2)

To draw the graph (1) is very easy. We can find the x and y values and thus two of the points on the line (1).

When $x = 0$, (1) gives $y = 5$.

Thus $A(0,5)$ is a point on the line.

When $y = 0$, (1) gives $x = 5$.

Thus $B(5,0)$ is another point on the line.

Plot A and B; join them to produce the line (1).

To draw the graph of (2), we can adopt the same procedure.

When $x = 0$, (2) gives $y = -4$.

Thus P(0,–4) is a point on the line.

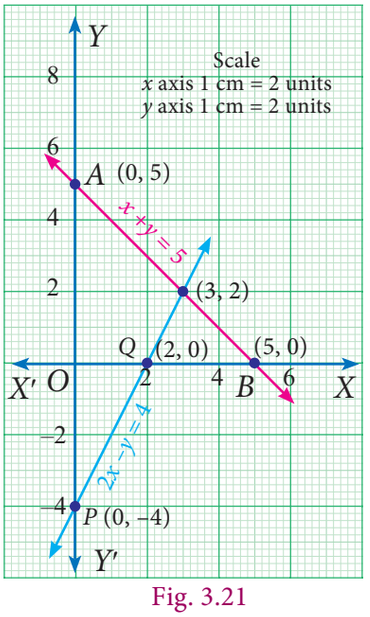


Fig. 3.21

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